

TECHNICAL ENGLISH SEMINAR

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The background is a solid light peach color. It features a collage of various papers and a notebook. A large, blank white rectangular piece of paper is the central focus, with a thin gold border. Behind it, there are several other papers: a green piece with a white grid pattern at the top, a brown piece with a white grid pattern on the right, and a blue spiral-bound notebook with a gold ring at the bottom left. The papers are layered and slightly offset, creating a sense of depth.

IDIOMS!



What are idioms?

An idiom is a phrase or expression that typically presents a figurative, non-literal meaning attached to the phrase; but some phrases become figurative idioms while retaining the literal meaning of the phrase. Categorized as formulaic language, an idiom's figurative meaning is different from the literal meaning.



RULES FOR IDIOMS:

- **An idiom is an expression that is taken figuratively and not literally,**
- **It is a complete sentence in itself.**
- **They have cultural values attached to themselves**
- **They are metaphorical in then the sense that if you extract the literal meaning of all words stated then it would be too un usual to believe or even farcical.**



Pros of idioms:

- **Using idioms shows familiarity with English. It demonstrates that you are comfortable with both formal and informal language .**
- **When you want to make your writing sound more conversational including idioms can give your writing a more relaxed tone.**
- **Because idioms add imagery, using them can make your writing more memorable. A sentence such as “She said it was time for him to have a taste of his own medicine” could be easier to remember because the reader can relate to the act of taking medicine or to the displeasure of a bad smell or taste.**



Cons of idioms:

- **Readers unfamiliar with a certain phrase might take it literally. For example, a man was so angry that he was “foaming at the mouth.” Because an illness like rabies could actually cause this to happen, a reader might wonder whether the phrase was meant metaphorically.**
- **Using idiomatic phrases could be distracting for readers who expect a formal tone.**
- **Scholars in scientific fields are likely to be accustomed to more formal writing, and phrases such as “the icing on the cake” or “a New York minute” might be seen as out of place in academic writing**



How and when do we use idioms:

- Idioms can be a powerful tool when used correctly and to make your writing sound more conversational. It's used in blog posts or emails.
- They add emphasis to important points .For fiction writers, idioms can add personality to the characters' voices. It's best to avoid idioms in technical or formal writing.
- Idioms leave a lot of room for misunderstandings, and they aren't precise Idioms are different from metaphors and analogies because idioms aren't about comparison.
- They are also different from proverbs. Proverbs are messages or truths, and they often offer advice, such as "an apple a day keeps the doctor away. The proverb's meaning is clear.

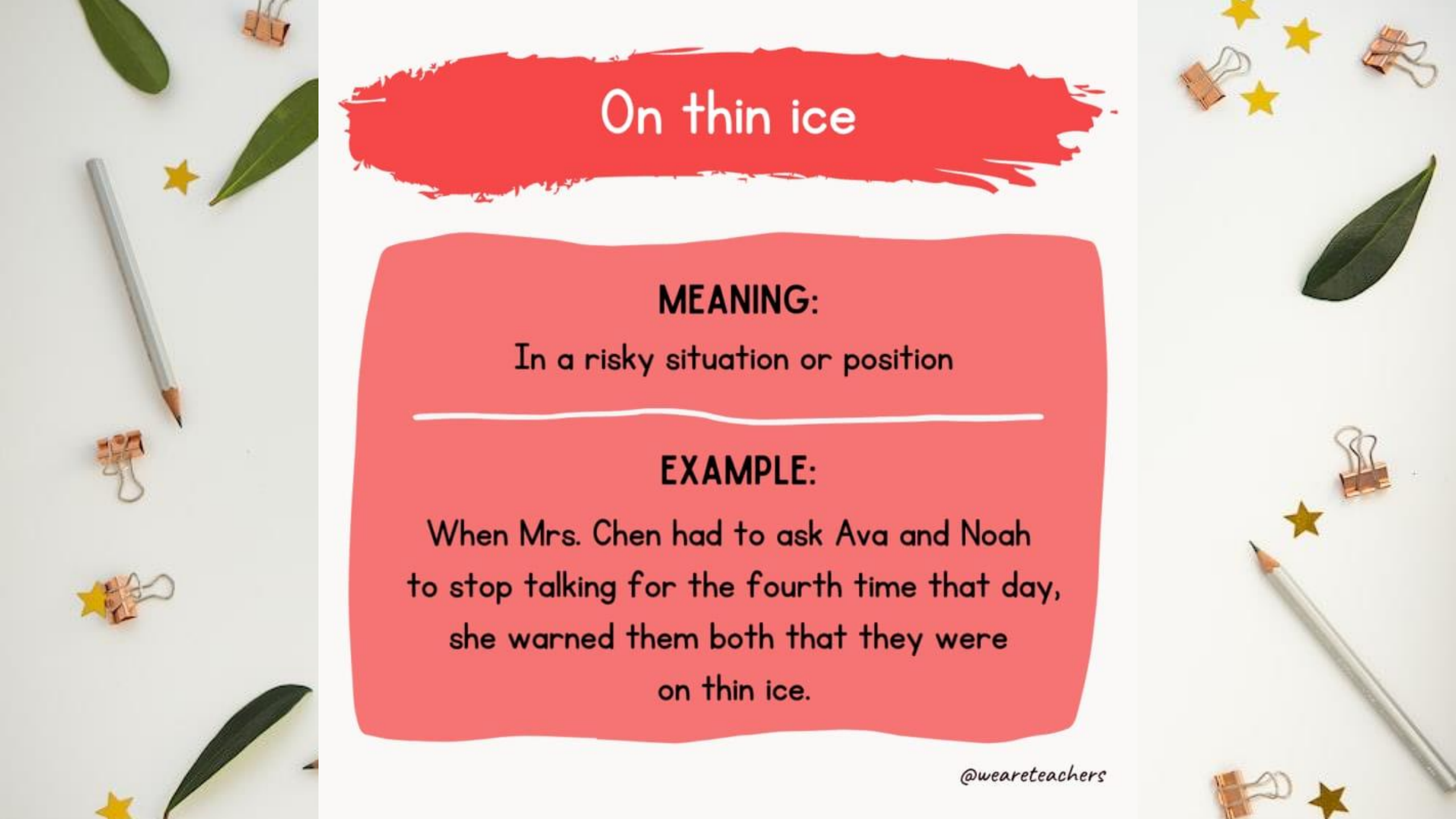
IDIOMS VS PROVERBS

IDIOMS

- Idiom is a fixed expression that contains a figurative meaning.
- Idioms do not contain a moral.
- Idioms are phrases not complete sentences.
- Idioms do not make sense, if you are not familiar with it.

PROVERBS

- Proverb is a short well-known saying that contains advice.
- Proverbs contain a moral or an advice based on the general truth.
- Proverbs are sentences.
- Proverbs can be understood even if you are hearing it for the first time.



On thin ice

MEANING:

In a risky situation or position

EXAMPLE:

When Mrs. Chen had to ask Ava and Noah to stop talking for the fourth time that day, she warned them both that they were on thin ice.

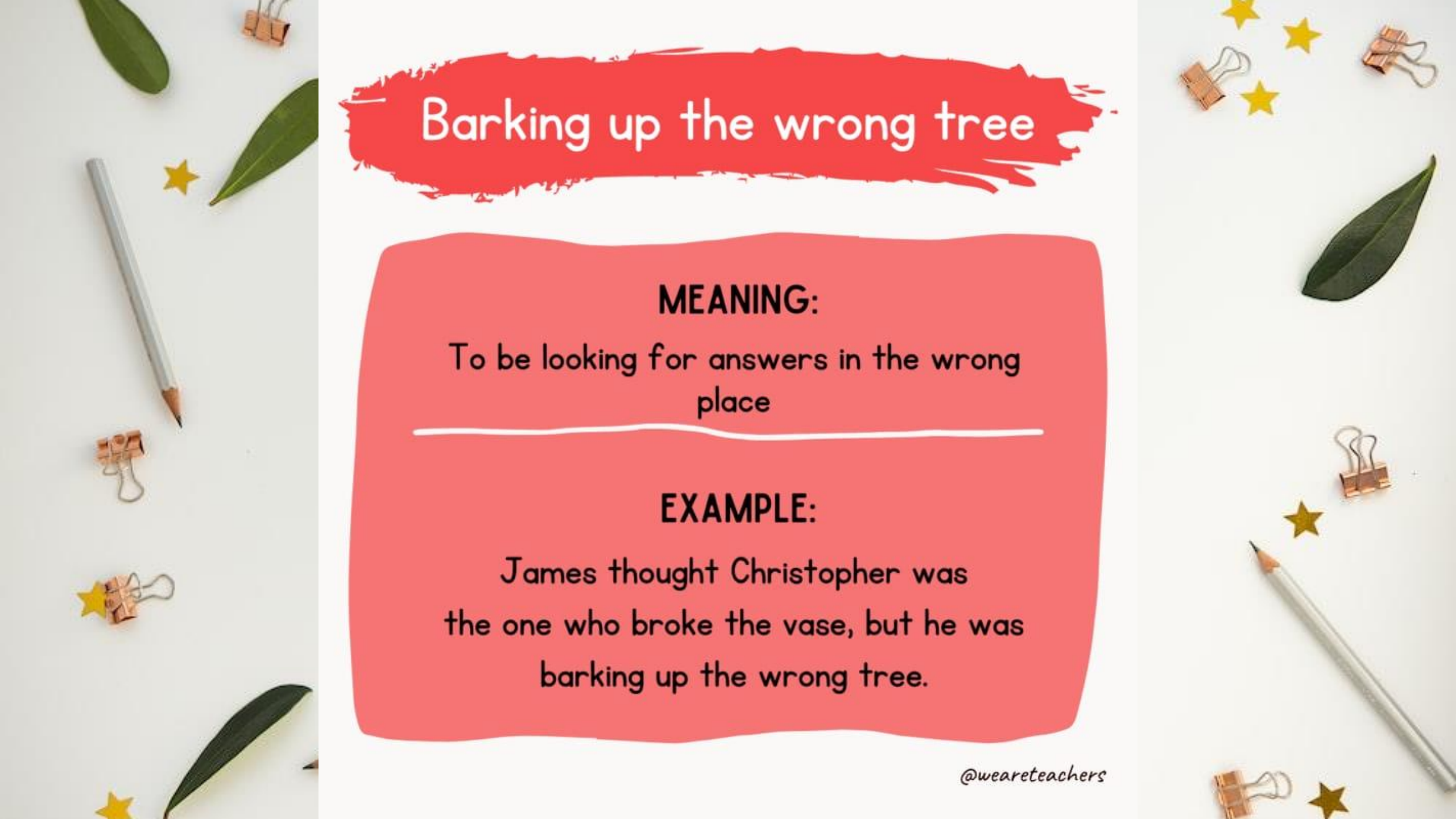
Get out of hand

MEANING:

To become difficult to control

EXAMPLE:

Ms. Rodriguez told her students they could chat while they worked, as long as the noise level didn't get out of hand.



Barking up the wrong tree

MEANING:

To be looking for answers in the wrong place

EXAMPLE:

James thought Christopher was the one who broke the vase, but he was barking up the wrong tree.

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**QUIZ
TIME!!**

ON TOP OF THE WORLD

MEANING:

On top of the world
means Extreme
Elation



BITE THE BULLET

MEANING: Bite the bullet means to just get over with something no matter how unpleasant it is.



KILL TWO BIRDS WITH ONE STONE

MEANING: Killing two
birds with one stone
means you have
accomplished two tasks at
once



OFF THE HOOK

MEANING: Off the hook means letting them getaway with something they did wrong or letting them out of a responsibility.



ON THIN ICE

MEANING: On thin ice means they are in a sensitive situation.



HIT THE NAIL ON THE HEAD

MEANING: Hit the nail on the head means to get something exactly right. It usually refers to an insight or an answer to a question.



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THANK YOU!!